the events preceding the Bretton Woods Conference even though these are not relevant from a strictly Indian perspective. However, the Bretton Woods Conference was of such moment, and the happenings of such interest, that I have taken the liberty of concluding that this digression is not unjustifiably tangential to the main theme. The nationalization of the RBI rounds off Part II of Book II.

Book III on the SBI starts with a brief history of the Presidency Banks and their amalgamation to form the Imperial Bank of India. It describes the emergence of the SBI in 1955 after the nationalization of the Imperial Bank. Purshotamdas's Chairmanship of the RBEC appointed in 1949, to consider *inter alia* the measures that could be immediately adopted for the extension of banking facilities in rural areas, also finds mention. Purshotamdas was also given the task of resolving the impasse which had occurred when the proposal to appoint the Imperial Bank's top brass after government or RBI approval met with vehement opposition from the Imperial Bank's Board. Since informal consultations failed to resolve the impasse, the government decided to refer this matter to the RBEC. The recommendations of the All India Rural Credit Survey (AIRCS) Committee, on the basis of which the Imperial Bank was nationalized, and the birth of the SBI are also covered in this section.

Raj Kumar Talwar's role as SBI Chairman is brought out in the last Chapter. Talwar who was the first professional banker to become Chairman was responsible for extending the bank's business manifold and his tenure saw the bank take several initiatives in the areas of innovative banking, rehabilitation of sick industries, and credit plans for rural development. He simplified procedures for financing of small-scale industries and launched new schemes for the benefit of small entrepreneurs, small businessmen, and agriculturists. Talwar also initiated and subsequent implemented the first ever organizational restructuring exercise of the bank in the early 1970s. He brought a moral and ethical dimension to banking and was known as much for his integrity and values, as for his professionalism. Talwar was unceremoniously eased out by the government when he refused to toe Sanjay Gandhi's line with the State Bank of India Act being specially amended to remove a man who is considered one of India's greatest bankers. His exit from the bank and the reasons for it are discussed in some detail.